QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH · PORTFOLIO CONSTRUCTION

Machine-Learning Investment Project

机器学习投资研究项目

Weekly cross-sectional return prediction and long-only portfolio construction on an 80-asset panel — one pipeline from data integrity checks to frozen out-of-sample weights.

在 80 只资产的面板上做周度横截面收益预测与 long-only 组合构建——一条从数据完整性检查直达冻结样本外权重的流水线。

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> **收益为模拟数据，方法为真。**面板的标的池取自一份真实的中国香港大型股指数成分股名单， 其收益与信号均为模拟生成，因此不可再分发；资产标识与行业分组一律匿名化。本报告描述的是一项研究练习—— 不是市场结果，也不是业绩记录。
>
> **Simulated returns, real methodology.** The panel is a real Hong Kong large-cap index constituent list carrying simulated returns and signals, which is why it cannot be redistributed; asset identifiers and industry buckets are anonymised throughout. The figures below describe a research exercise — not market results and not a performance record.

MAIN FINDINGS | 主要发现

最好的预测模型不是最好的组合。 验证周 79–104 上，四信号 LASSO 的 OOS R^2 达 +0.008700，却输掉了组合表：它的 top-16 long-only 夏普为 +4.4086，低于随机森林的 +4.8950。 预测误差与横截面排序是两个不同的目标。

The best predictor is not the best portfolio. LASSO reaches OOS R^2 +0.008700 on weeks 79–104, yet its top-16 long-only Sharpe is +4.4086 against the random forest's +4.8950. Forecast error and cross-sectional ranking are different objectives.

额外灵活性有害。 全部 17 个信号上的 OLS 验证 OOS R^2 为负（−0.020575），收缩把它拉回正 （+0.0087）。浅层随机森林比零预测还差（−0.041561），而树的深度每加一级，验证误差就更大。

Extra flexibility hurt. OLS on all 17 signals overfits; shrinkage repairs the sign. A shallow random forest is worse than the zero forecast, and every extra tree depth makes validation error larger.

最终策略：随机森林预测 + top-14 long-only，每只 7.14%。 验证夏普 +5.1522，信息比率 +10.1914， 最大回撤 −0.0402——在测试的 33 条规则中回撤第二浅。标准化器与森林在第 1–104 周重拟合后， 对第 105–260 周保持冻结。

Final strategy: random-forest forecasts, top-14 long-only at 7.14% each. Validation Sharpe +5.1522, IR +10.1914, MDD −0.0402 — the second-shallowest drawdown of the 33 rules tested. Refitted on weeks 1–104, then frozen for weeks 105–260.

风险仍然是集中度。 验证期单周最大的行业配置为 92.86%（第 103 周）。在 156 个私有评估周中， 最大行业权重平均仍达 62.2%，在 17 周超过 80%，并在 2 周达到 100%。

The risk that remains is concentration. The largest validation-week sector allocation is 92.86%. Across the 156 evaluation weeks the largest sector weight still averages 62.2%.

All numerical observations in this report are simulated. Performance evidence covers the 26 validation weeks only; evaluation-window outcomes are withheld.

本报告中所有数值观测均为模拟生成。业绩证据仅覆盖 26 个验证周；评估窗口的结果被隐藏。

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1. Overview | 概览

本研究提出两个经常被混为一谈的问题：

1. **17 个模拟信号能否在样本外预测下周超额收益？** 能，但只能算勉强，而且必须先做收缩（shrinkage）。
2. **预测最好的模型，是否也构建出最好的组合？** 并不是，而且这个反转足够尖锐，是本研究的主要发现。

一个 80 只资产 × 260 个预测周的周度面板按日期划分（**绝不打乱**）为 78 个训练周、26 个验证周，以及一个结果被隐藏的 156 周评估窗口。七个阶段端到端运行：

阶段	作用
0	数据完整性检查
1	目标定义与零预测基准
2	线性模型：OLS 与在验证集上调参的 LASSO
3	一个非线性模型：随机森林，在复杂度阶梯上选择
4	基于 drop-to-zero OOS R^2 的重要性分析
5	组合构建：33 条 long-only top-K 规则，用三窗口稳健综合评分
6	按窗口对整族规则重新评分，检验稳定性
7	在第 1–104 周上重拟合一次，冻结，然后产出 156 个评估周的权重向量

每一个超参数都在这 26 个验证周上选择。评估窗口只被使用一次，用来产出最终权重。

> The study asks two questions that are often conflated:
>
> 1. **Can 17 simulated signals predict next-week excess returns out of sample?** They can — but barely, and only after shrinkage.
> 2. **Does the model that predicts best also build the best portfolio?** It does not, and the reversal is sharp enough to be the main finding.
>
> A weekly panel of 80 assets × 260 forecast dates is split by date (never shuffled) into 78 training weeks, 26 validation weeks and a 156-week evaluation window whose outcomes are withheld. Seven stages run end to end:
>
> | Stage | Purpose |
> |---|---|
> | 0 | Data integrity checks |
> | 1 | Target definition and the zero-forecast benchmark |
> | 2 | Linear models: OLS and a validation-tuned LASSO |
> | 3 | One nonlinear model: random forest, chosen on a complexity ladder |
> | 4 | Importance analysis by drop-to-zero OOS R^2 |
> | 5 | Portfolio construction: 33 long-only top-K rules scored on a three-window composite |
> | 6 | Per-window re-scoring of the whole rule family |
> | 7 | Refit once on weeks 1–104, freeze, write 156 weekly weight vectors |
>
> Every hyper-parameter is selected on the 26 validation weeks. The evaluation window is used exactly once, to produce the final weights.

2. Data and the zero-forecast benchmark | 数据与零预测基准

表 1. 各划分的样本量

划分	周数	资产数	行数	结果变量
训练	78	80	6,240	可见
验证	26	80	2,080	可见
评估	156	80	12,480	隐藏

目标变量为 `y = ret_next_week − rf_weekly`，单位是十进制周度超额收益，且已与其预测行对齐。在 6,240 个训练行上，均值为 **−0.0010226791**，样本标准差（n − 1）为 **0.0565097717**。均值为负，因此截距是有意义的，零预测并不等于样本均值。只有 17 个预测因子被用作输入；资产编号、标签与行业标签都是标识符，不是特征。

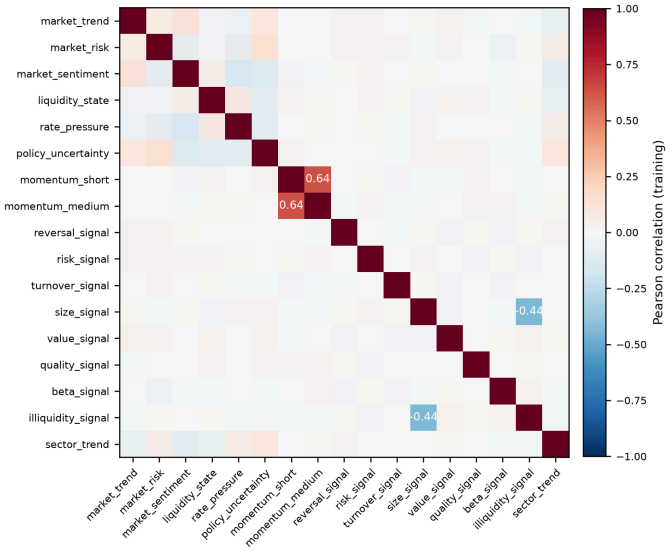


图 1. 17 个预测因子的训练相关矩阵（仅用 6,240 个训练行）；|r| ≥ 0.25 的格子已标注。

绝对值最大的非对角元素对是 `momentum_short` ↔ `momentum_medium`，相关系数 **+0.6399936121**；次之是 `size_signal` ↔ `illiquidity_signal`，为 −0.4421681987。除这两对之外，所有 |相关系数| 都低于 0.17，因此这 17 个预测因子接近正交——单靠相关性并不足以支持删除任何一个。

为什么必须保留日历顺序与完整的周。 17 个预测因子中有 6 个在周内对 80 只资产完全相同，`rf_weekly` 也是一个单一的周度数字。若按"资产-周"随机切分，同一周的一部分资产会进训练集、另一部分进验证集，模型就等于看到了那一周的市场状态。因此每一周都按日历顺序完整保留，使验证块模拟的正是"在每个预测时点只掌握过去信息"的投资者。

基准。 零预测对每一行都预测零超额收益，其验证 MSE 为 **0.0030908984**（训练 MSE 0.0031938884；验证集目标平方和 6.4290686681）。对下面每一个模型，都有 OOS $R^2 = 1 - \Sigma(y - \hat{y})^2 / \Sigma y^2$，因此负值意味着比预测零还差。

> Table 1. Sample counts by split

Split	Weeks	Assets	Rows	Outcomes
Training	78	80	6,240	visible
Validation	26	80	2,080	visible
Evaluation	156	80	12,480	withheld

The target is `y = ret_next_week − rf_weekly`, in decimal weekly excess returns, already aligned to its forecast row. Over the 6,240 training rows the mean is **−0.0010226791** and the sample standard deviation (n − 1) is **0.0565097717**. The mean is negative, so the intercept matters and the zero forecast is not the sample mean. Only the 17 predictors are used as inputs; asset ids, labels and sector labels are identifiers, not features.

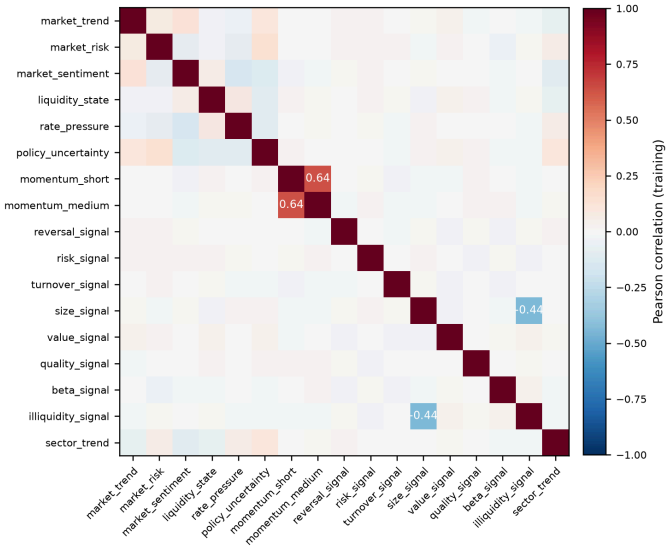


Figure 1. Training correlation matrix of the 17 predictors (6,240 training rows only); cells with |r| ≥ 0.25 are labelled.

The strongest absolute off-diagonal pair is `momentum_short` ↔ `momentum_medium` at **+0.6399936121**; the next is `size_signal` ↔ `illiquidity_signal` at −0.4421681987. Apart from those two pairs every |correlation| is below 0.17, so the 17 predictors are close to orthogonal — correlation alone does not justify deleting one.

Why the calendar order and whole weeks are kept. Six of the 17 predictors are identical across the 80 assets within a week, and `rf_weekly` is a single weekly number. A random asset-week split would place some assets of one week in training and others in validation, letting the model see that week's market state. Each week is therefore kept intact in calendar order, so the validation block imitates an investor who only knows the past at each forecast date.

Benchmark. The zero forecast predicts zero excess return for every row. Its validation MSE is **0.0030908984** (training MSE 0.0031938884; sum of squared validation targets 6.4290686681). For every model below, OOS $R^2 = 1 - \Sigma(y - \hat{y})^2 / \Sigma y^2$, so a negative value means worse than predicting zero.

3. Linear models: OLS and LASSO | 线性模型：OLS 与 LASSO

两个模型都是带非惩罚截距的合并回归，在全部 6,240 个训练行上拟合，预测因子先按**仅由训练集**的均值与标准差标准化。OLS 使用 `LinearRegression`；LASSO 使用 `Lasso`，求解器为循环坐标法（cyclic-coordinate），容差 1e-10，`max_iter` 200,000，最小化 $SSE/(2n) + \alpha \cdot \Sigma|\beta_j|$。全程不使用任何打乱的交叉验证。

表 2. 预测结果（MSE 单位为平方十进制收益；OOS R^2 为十进制）

模型 Model	训练 MSE Train MSE	验证 MSE Val MSE	验证 OOS R^2
零预测 Zero forecast	0.0031938884	0.0030908984	0.0000000000
OLS	0.0031130152	0.0031544950	−0.0205754475
LASSO（α = 0.0028011752）	0.0031551909	0.0030640089	+0.0086995595
随机森林 Random forest	0.0029414926	0.0032193579	−0.0415605689

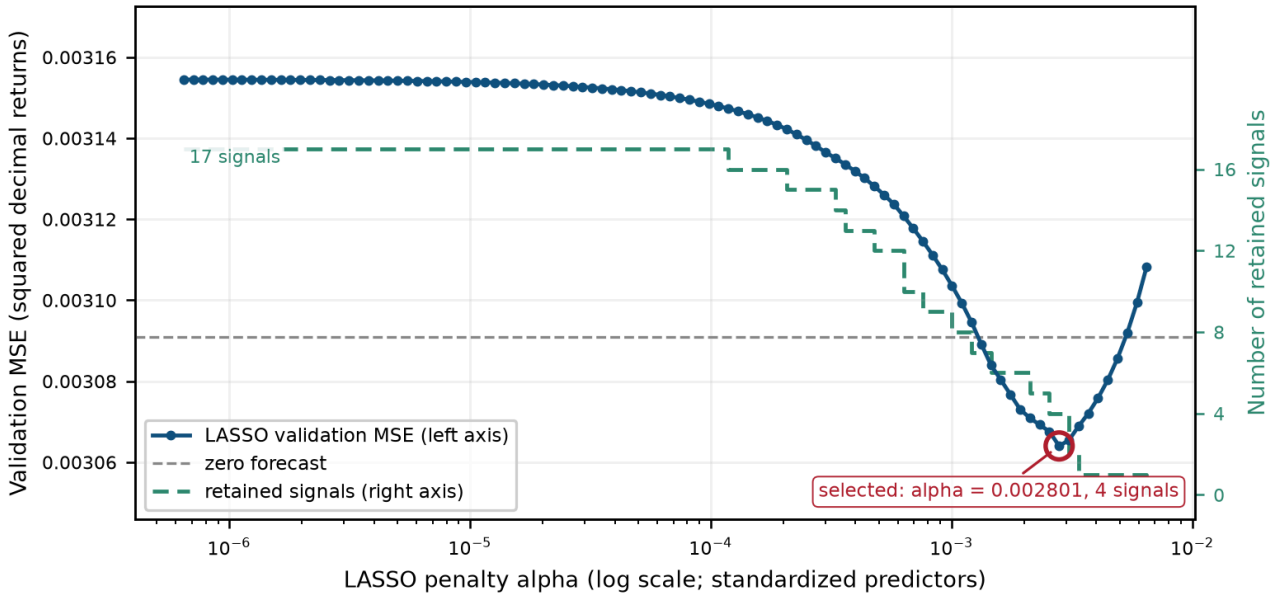


图 2. 验证 MSE 对 LASSO 惩罚项（对数刻度，左轴）。灰色虚线为零预测基准；绿色阶梯曲线（右轴）为保留的非零系数个数。

$\alpha_{max} = \max|X'(y - \bar{y})|/n$ = **0.0064710781**，仅由训练数据计算。在从 $\alpha_{max} \cdot 10^{-4}$ 到 α_{max} 的 100 个对数等距惩罚项上，最低的验证 MSE 出现在 **α = 0.0028011752**，保留 **17 个斜率中的 4 个**（验证 MSE 0.0030640089，OOS R^2 +0.0086995595）。所选点位于网格内部，并非边界。

曲线是平的，这一点很重要。 在 α 落在 [0.15·α_max, 0.46·α_max]（即 0.000970662 到 0.002976696，跨 12 个网格点）这一段上，验证 MSE 仅在 0.0030640089 与 0.0031035289 之间变动（跨度 **1.29%**），而保留集合从 8 个信号收缩到 4 个。惩罚项的排序并非刀锋般敏感，因此不应把那个精确的 α 值当作有经济意义的结果。一处需要提醒：LASSO 的截距等于训练均值，所以在惩罚极大时，该模型预测的是训练均值而不是零。

表 3. 标准化系数（截距单独列示）

预测因子 Predictor	OLS	所选 LASSO
截距 intercept	−0.0010226791	−0.0010226791
market_trend	+0.0017780617	0
market_risk	+0.0019947431	+0.0000150212
market_sentiment	−0.0016787078	0
liquidity_state	−0.0005016862	0
rate_pressure	−0.0027584277	−0.0001411235
policy_uncertainty	+0.0014924866	0
momentum_short	−0.0008702420	0
momentum_medium	+0.0014350886	0
reversal_signal	+0.0006500409	0
risk_signal	+0.0007796242	0
turnover_signal	−0.0003453226	0
size_signal	−0.0009922023	0
value_signal	+0.0030151058	+0.0004521775
quality_signal	+0.0064684204	+0.0036680868
beta_signal	−0.0001335541	0
illiquidity_signal	+0.0003153755	0
sector_trend	−0.0002469338	0

LASSO 保留了 `market_risk`、`rate_pressure`、`value_signal` 与 `quality_signal`。变量选择确实有帮助，但幅度不大：在全部 17 个预测因子上的 OLS 验证 OOS R^2 为负（−0.0205754475），而 LASSO 把符号拉回了正（+0.0086995595）。完整回归在 6,240 行上过拟合；收缩剔除了足够多的噪声，才让符号在样本外转正。**但请注意**：惩罚项正是在这同样 26 周上挑出来的，因此这一改进并不是未被触碰的测试集结果。

> Both models are pooled regressions with an unpenalised intercept, fitted on all 6,240 training rows after standardising the 17 predictors with training means and standard deviations only. OLS uses `LinearRegression`; LASSO uses `Lasso` with a cyclic-coordinate solver, tolerance 1e-10, `max_iter` 200,000, minimising SSE/(2n) + α·Σ|β_j|. No shuffled cross-validation is used anywhere.
>
> **Table 2. Prediction results** (MSE in squared decimal returns; OOS R^2 as a decimal)

Model	Training MSE	Validation MSE	Validation OOS R^2
Zero forecast	0.0031938884	0.0030908984	0.0000000000
OLS	0.0031130152	0.0031544950	−0.0205754475
LASSO (α = 0.0028011752)	0.0031551909	0.0030640089	+0.0086995595
Random forest	0.0029414926	0.0032193579	−0.0415605689

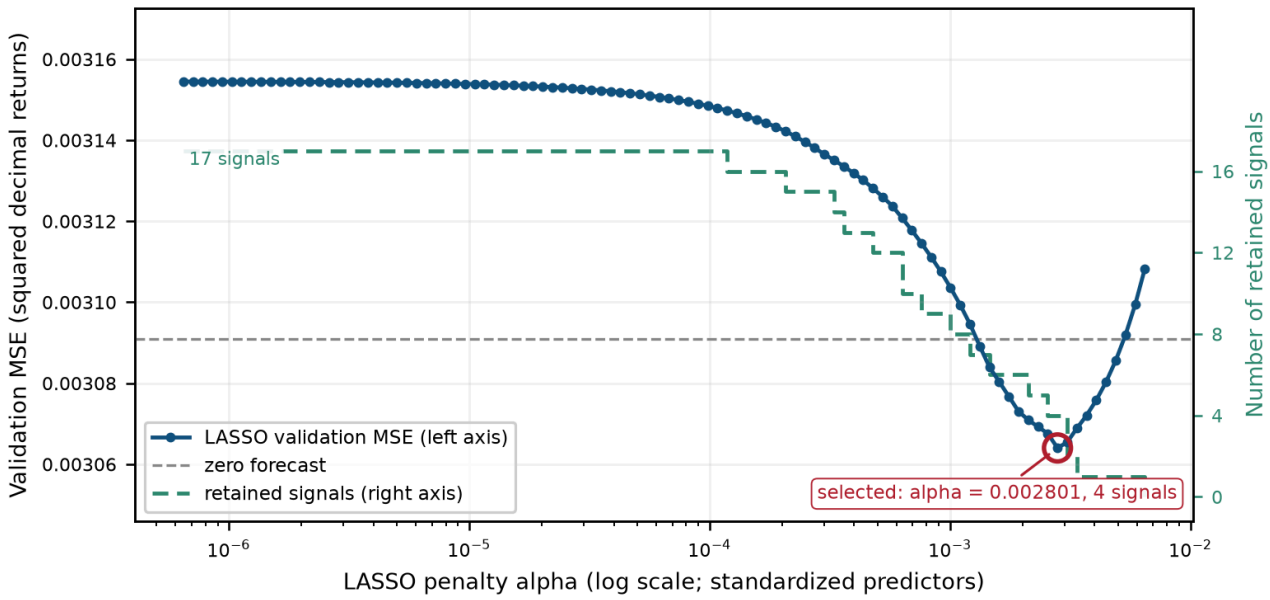


Figure 2. Validation MSE against the LASSO penalty on a log scale (left axis). The grey dashed line is the zero forecast; the green step curve (right axis) is the number of retained signals.

$\alpha_{max} = \max|X'(y - \bar{y})|/n =$ **0.0064710781**, computed from training data only. Across 100 log-spaced penalties from $\alpha_{max} \cdot 10^{-4}$ to α_{max}, the lowest validation MSE is at **α = 0.0028011752**, retaining **4 of 17 slopes** (validation MSE 0.0030640089, OOS R^2 +0.0086995595). The selected point is interior, not on a grid boundary.

The curve is flat, and that matters. Over the window $\alpha \in [0.15 \cdot \alpha_{max}, 0.46 \cdot \alpha_{max}]$ (that is 0.000970662 to 0.002976696, 12 grid points) the validation MSE moves only between 0.0030640089 and 0.0031035289 (a **1.29%** range) while the retained set shrinks from 8 to 4 signals. The ranking of penalties is not knife-edge, and the exact penalty should not be read as economically meaningful. One caution: the LASSO intercept equals the training mean, so at very large penalties the model predicts that mean rather than zero.

Table 3. Standardised coefficients (intercept reported separately)

Predictor	OLS	Selected LASSO
intercept	−0.0010226791	−0.0010226791
market_trend	+0.0017780617	0
market_risk	+0.0019947431	+0.0000150212
market_sentiment	−0.0016787078	0
liquidity_state	−0.0005016862	0
rate_pressure	−0.0027584277	−0.0001411235
policy_uncertainty	+0.0014924866	0
momentum_short	−0.0008702420	0
momentum_medium	+0.0014350886	0
reversal_signal	+0.0006500409	0
risk_signal	+0.0007796242	0
turnover_signal	−0.0003453226	0
size_signal	−0.0009922023	0
value_signal	+0.0030151058	+0.0004521775
quality_signal	+0.0064684204	+0.0036680868
beta_signal	−0.0001335541	0
illiquidity_signal	+0.0003153755	0
sector_trend	−0.0002469338	0

LASSO retains `market_risk`, `rate_pressure`, `value_signal` and `quality_signal`. Selection helps, but only slightly: OLS on all 17 predictors has a negative validation OOS R^2 (−0.0205754475) while LASSO recovers +0.0086995595. The full regression overfits 6,240 rows; shrinkage removes enough noise to move the sign out of sample. **One caution:** the penalty was chosen on these same 26 weeks, so this improvement is not an untouched-test result.

4. A nonlinear model: random forest | 非线性模型：随机森林

森林平均 300 棵树，每棵在训练行的 bootstrap 样本上拟合，输入为随机子集（`max_features = sqrt(17) = 4`），平方误差分裂，`min_samples_split = 2`，随机种子 2026。复杂度在 `max_depth ∈ {2, 4, 8}` × `min_samples_leaf ∈ {30, 60}` 上变化——阶梯从深度 2 起步，因为一棵树需要两次分裂才能表达交互项，而这正是我们关心的非线性。

表 4. 森林设定与验证 MSE

最大深度 Depth	最小叶节点 Leaf	训练 MSE	验证 MSE	验证 OOS R^2
2	30	0.0029399988	0.0032231428	−0.0427850999
2	**60**	**0.0029414926**	**0.0032193579**	**−0.0415605689**
4	30	0.0025479311	0.0033543030	−0.0852194460
4	60	0.0025951406	0.0033251511	−0.0757879172
8	30	0.0020571795	0.0035064431	−0.1344414129
8	60	0.0021962617	0.0033997844	−0.0999340458

最低验证 MSE 选出深度 2 / 叶节点 60（表中加粗行）。两项独立检查确认实现无误：在 2,080 个验证行上，森林预测恰好等于其 300 棵树预测的均值；把输入替换为正仿射映射后重拟合，预测值不变（最大绝对偏差 8.7e-19）。第二项检查只覆盖仿射缩放——非线性的单调映射仍可能让样本跨过某个分裂阈值。

沿复杂度阶梯每上一级，训练误差都下降、验证误差都上升，且没有任何一个设定能打败零预测。有一个结构性事实可以解释：即使是这个浅森林，也把 **86.2%** 的内建分裂重要性放在那 6 个市场级预测因子上——而它们在周内对 80 只资产完全相同。这些变量自身无法在周内给资产排序；树只能借助它们来决定"由哪个别的变量来做这次分裂"，所以它们承载的重要性并不会转化为横截面顺序。

> The forest averages 300 trees, each on a bootstrap sample of training rows with a random subset of inputs (`max_features = sqrt(17) = 4`), squared-error splits, `min_samples_split = 2`, seed 2026. Complexity is varied over `max_depth ∈ {2, 4, 8}` × `min_samples_leaf ∈ {30, 60}` — the ladder starts at depth 2 because a tree needs two splits to express an interaction, which is exactly the nonlinearity of interest.
>
> **Table 4. Forest settings and validation MSE**
>
> | Max depth | Min. leaf | Training MSE | Validation MSE | Validation OOS R^2 |
> |---|---|---|---|---|
> | 2 | 30 | 0.0029399988 | 0.0032231428 | −0.0427850999 |
> | **2** | **60** | **0.0029414926** | **0.0032193579** | **−0.0415605689** |
> | 4 | 30 | 0.0025479311 | 0.0033543030 | −0.0852194460 |
> | 4 | 60 | 0.0025951406 | 0.0033251511 | −0.0757879172 |
> | 8 | 30 | 0.0020571795 | 0.0035064431 | −0.1344414129 |
> | 8 | 60 | 0.0021962617 | 0.0033997844 | −0.0999340458 |
>
> Minimum validation MSE selects depth 2 / leaf 60 (selected row above). Two independent checks confirm the implementation: on the 2,080 validation rows the forest prediction equals the mean of its 300 tree predictions, and refitting on a positive affine map of the inputs changes no prediction (largest absolute difference 8.7e-19). The second check covers affine rescalings only — a non-linear monotone map can move rows across a split threshold.
>
> **Every step up the complexity ladder lowers training error and raises validation error**, and no setting beats the zero forecast. One structural fact explains why: the shallow forest still places **86.2%** of its built-in split importance on the six market predictors that are identical across the 80 assets within a week. Those variables cannot rank assets within a week on their own; a tree can only use them to choose which *other* variable does the splitting, so the importance they carry does not translate into cross-sectional order.

5. Importance analysis | 重要性分析

所选森林在第 1–78 周上拟合一次，之后不再重拟合。每次取一个标准化后的验证集预测因子，把它的整列置零——在同一个标准化器下，这等于把该因子替换为其训练均值——然后在同样那 2,080 行上重新计算 OOS R^2。重要性 = 原 OOS R^2 − 替换后 OOS R^2。与常见的"训练集拟合变体"不同，这里用的是**验证集**的 OOS R^2。重要性是预测意义上的，不是因果意义上的，且相关的信号可能共享信用。

基准 OOS R^2 = −0.0415605689。

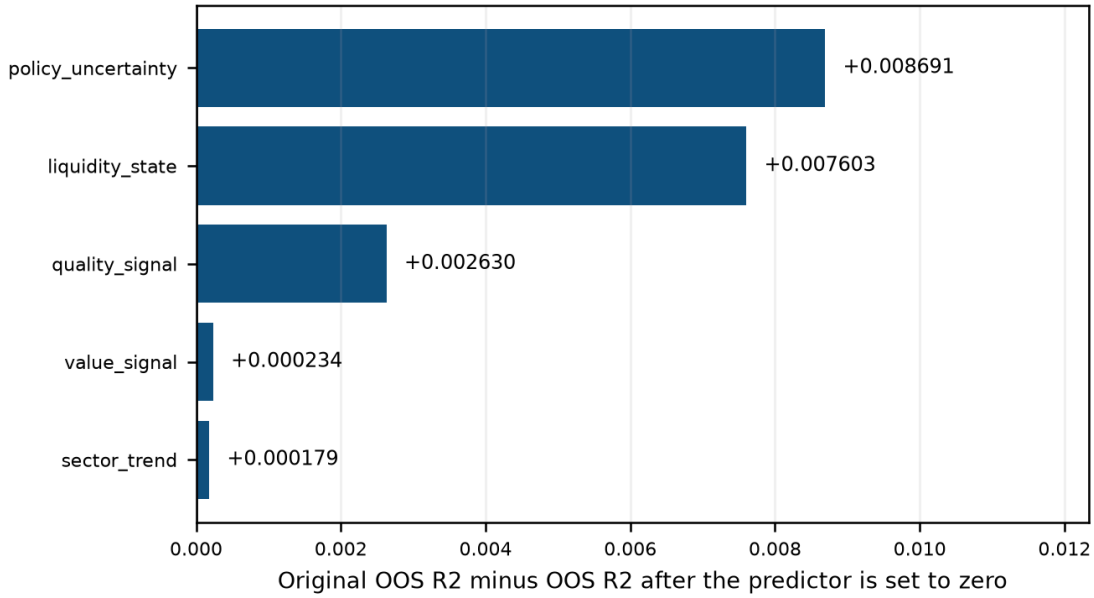


图 3. 最大的五个带符号 drop-to-zero 重要性得分。

表 5. 最大的五个 drop-to-zero 得分

排名	预测因子	重要性
1	policy_uncertainty	+0.0086911000
2	liquidity_state	+0.0076031920
3	quality_signal	+0.0026298300
4	value_signal	+0.0002336646
5	sector_trend	+0.0001793685

有 8 个预测因子的得分为负，而且这些负值是有信息量的：把 `market_trend` 置零**反而让** OOS R^2 提升了 0.0274132449，也就是说样本外来看，森林对它的依赖是训练样本的产物。其余最负的依次是 `rate_pressure`（−0.010325）、`market_sentiment`（−0.003303）与 `market_risk`（−0.002156）。

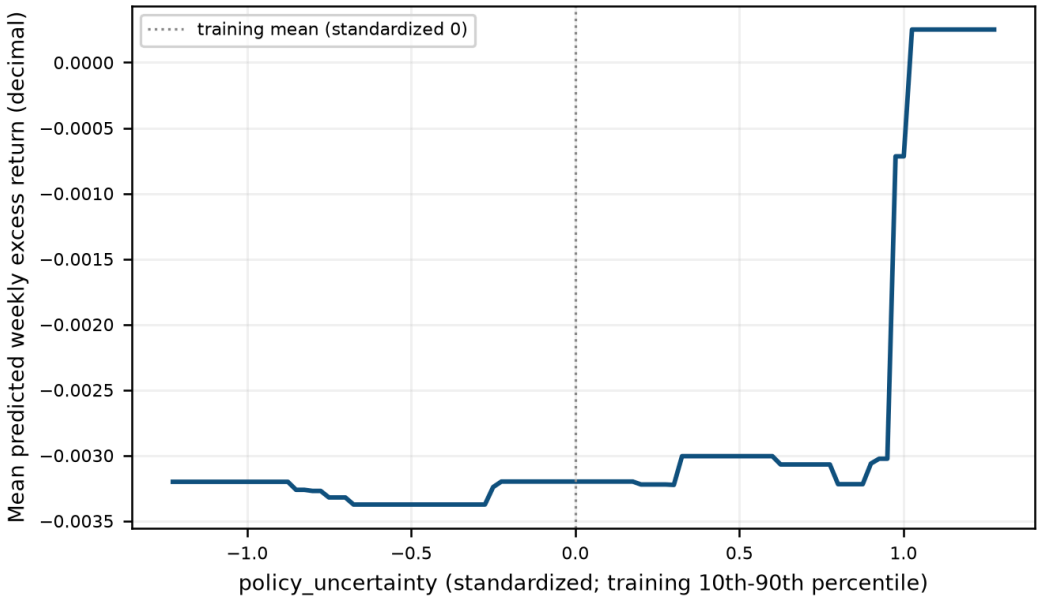


图 4. 在训练集 10%–90% 分位区间内，最重要预测因子的平均响应曲线。每个验证行保留其余全部输入的自身取值，预测在 2,080 行上取平均。

最重要的预测因子是 `policy_uncertainty`。在所评估的区间内（标准化后 −1.2264495953 到 +1.2761109476），平均预测从 −0.0032013596 变为 +0.0002515380，在十进制周度超额收益上变化了 **+0.0034528976。**曲线是分段常数、含一个非单调区段，并在 +1 个标准差附近陡然上升——这是树阈值的特征，而不是平滑的效应。它描述的是这个已拟合的模型，不是因果效应；而且该森林的基准 OOS R^2 为负，解读它的依赖结构并不能让它成为一个成功的预测器。

与 LASSO 的对比。 LASSO 保留了 4 个信号，其中 **2** 个出现在森林的前五名（`quality_signal`、`value_signal`）。`market_risk` 与 `rate_pressure` 在森林前五之外；而 `policy_uncertainty`、`liquidity_state` 与 `sector_trend` 被森林倚重，却没有被 LASSO 保留。这种重叠是部分的，也是结构性的：惩罚线性模型只能通过斜率使用一个预测因子，而树可以用它来划分资产、并在每个叶子里拟合一个不同的水平。在种子 0、42、123 与 9999 下重拟合森林，每次都返回相同的前三（`liquidity_state`、`policy_uncertainty`、`quality_signal`），因此这个排序不是种子带来的假象。

> The selected forest is fitted once on weeks 1–78 and never refitted. For one standardised validation predictor at a time, its whole column is set to zero — equal to that predictor's training mean under the same scaler — and the OOS R^2 is recomputed on the same 2,080 rows. Importance = original OOS R^2 − replaced OOS R^2. Unlike the common training-fit variant, this uses validation OOS R^2. Importance is predictive, not causal, and correlated signals can share credit.
>
> Baseline OOS R^2 = −0.0415605689.

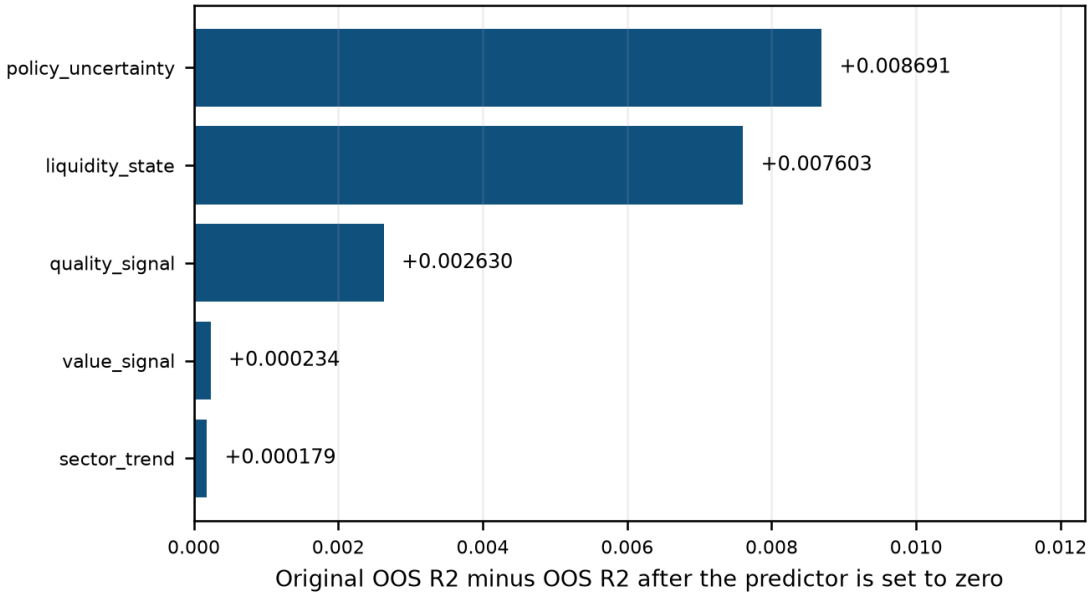


Figure 3. Five largest signed drop-to-zero importance scores.

Table 5. Five largest drop-to-zero scores

Rank	Predictor	Importance
1	policy_uncertainty	+0.0086911000
2	liquidity_state	+0.0076031920
3	quality_signal	+0.0026298300
4	value_signal	+0.0002336646
5	sector_trend	+0.0001793685

Eight predictors carry a negative score, and they are informative: setting `market_trend` to zero *raises* the OOS R^2 by 0.0274132449, so out of sample the forest's reliance on it is a training-sample artefact. The next most negative are `rate_pressure` (−0.010325), `market_sentiment` (−0.003303) and `market_risk` (−0.002156).

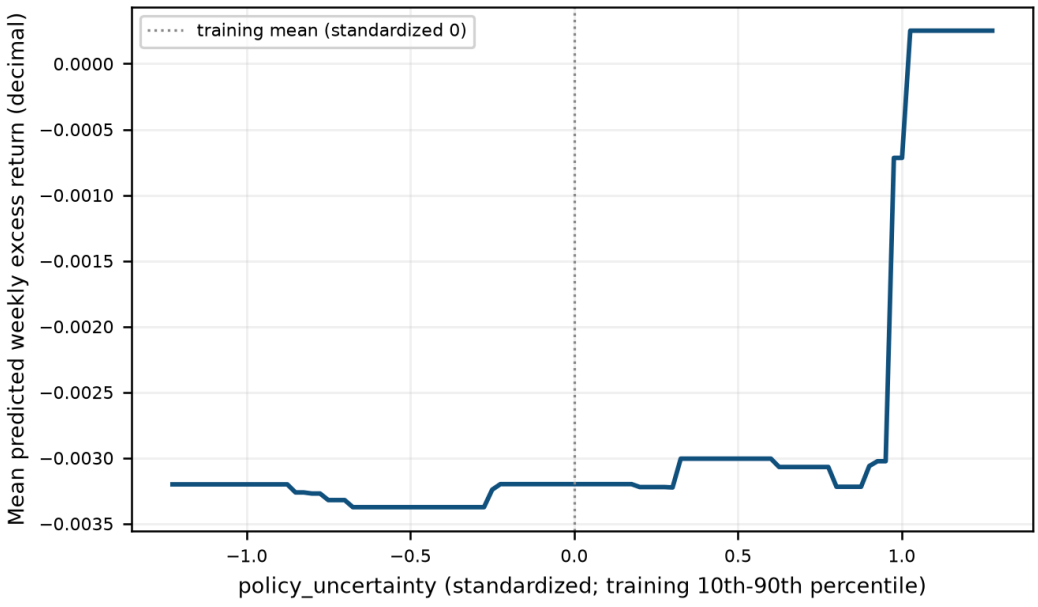


Figure 4. Average response to the most important predictor between its training 10th and 90th percentiles. Each validation row keeps its own values for all other inputs; predictions are averaged over the 2,080 rows.

The most important predictor is `policy_uncertainty`. Over the evaluated range (−1.2264495953 to +1.2761109476 standardised) the mean prediction moves from −0.0032013596 to +0.0002515380, a change of **+0.0034528976** in decimal weekly excess return. The curve is piecewise constant with a non-monotonic segment and a sharp rise near +1 standard deviation — the signature of tree thresholds rather than a smooth effect. It describes this fitted model, not a causal effect; and the forest's baseline OOS R^2 is negative, so interpreting its reliance does not make it a successful forecaster.

Comparison with LASSO. LASSO retained 4 signals; of these **2** appear in the forest's top five (`quality_signal`, `value_signal`). `market_risk` and `rate_pressure` are outside the forest's top five, while `policy_uncertainty`, `liquidity_state` and `sector_trend` are relied on by the forest but not retained by LASSO. The overlap is partial and structural: a penalised linear model uses a predictor only through its slope, whereas a tree can partition assets with it and fit a different level in each leaf. Refitting the forest under seeds 0, 42, 123 and 9999 returns the same top three predictors (`liquidity_state`, `policy_uncertainty`, `quality_signal`) every time, so the ranking is not a seed artefact.

6. Portfolio construction | 组合构建

在每个验证周，按预测超额收益对 80 只资产降序排名，并列时按 `asset_id` 升序打破平局。多空组合等权持有前 16 名并做空后 16 名；long-only 组合等权持有前 K 名，其余持 0。夏普比率 = √52 × mean(r_p − r_f)/sd(r_p − r_f)，信息比率 = √52 × mean(r_p − r_EW)/sd(r_p − r_EW)，两者标准差均取样本标准差。最大回撤从财富 1 开始按总收益复利计算，并以非正数报告。交易成本被忽略。

表 6. 验证集组合（第 79–104 周；十进制）

模型 / 规则 Model / rule	周度多空价差	Long-only 夏普	相对等权 IR	最大回撤
OLS / top 16	+0.0220083	4.4530	7.8654	−0.0477
LASSO / top 16	+0.0208958	4.4086	10.3092	−0.0478
随机森林 / top 16 Random forest	+0.0244138	4.8950	9.8742	−0.0426
80 只等权 80-asset equal weight	—	1.7803	0.0000	−0.0777

预测最好的模型是否给出了最好的组合？不是。 验证集上预测最好的是 LASSO（OOS R^2 +0.0087），但最大的多空价差与最好的 long-only 夏普都属于随机森林，而后者的 OOS R^2 是负的（−0.0416）。OOS R^2 度量的是收益**水平**上的数值拟合；而 top-K 规则只使用预测值在**周内**的横截面**顺序**——把某一周的全部预测值乘以同一个正常数，持仓完全不变。因此这两个模型的差别出在排序本身，而不是预测值的离散程度：LASSO 只保留 17 个斜率中的 4 个，且这些斜率并不是 OLS 斜率的公共倍数；而森林在阈值与交互项上划分资产。改变 top-K 规则的是**模型形式**，不是预测尺度的收缩。

选择 K。 33 条 long-only top-K 规则（K ∈ {10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 20, 24, 32, 40} × 3 个模型；K 低于 10 会突破 10% 持仓上限）按 夏普 8 / IR 6 / 回撤 6 的权重打分。为了避免选中"在某一段周上恰好好看"的 K，加权百分位得分分别在完整验证块与其两个半块上计算，候选按三个窗口得分的**均值**排序。

表 7. 按三窗口综合评分排名前八的候选

模型 / 规则	夏普	IR	最大回撤	综合评分
随机森林 / top 14	**5.1522**	**10.1914**	**−0.0402**	**17.131**
随机森林 / top 15	4.8799	10.3675	−0.0452	15.596
随机森林 / top 16	4.8950	9.8742	−0.0426	14.263
随机森林 / top 11	5.1993	9.4462	−0.0434	14.222
随机森林 / top 10	5.4809	9.3871	−0.0484	14.121
OLS / top 10	5.1739	7.5019	−0.0416	14.040
随机森林 / top 20	4.6504	11.2416	−0.0436	13.939
随机森林 / top 13	4.9822	8.8525	−0.0424	13.697

赢家"随机森林 / top 14"的综合评分为 17.131，亚军为 15.596；而它最弱窗口的得分（15.091）是所有候选中**最高的**最差窗口得分——因此这次选择并不依赖某一段走运的窗口。

稳定性检查没有展示的东西。 单一指标彼此并不一致：完整块上最高的夏普是"随机森林 / top 10"（5.4809），最高的信息比率是"随机森林 / top 20"（11.2416），最浅的回撤是"OLS / top 11"（−0.0395）。而且夏普最优的 K 在窗口之间会移动（完整块是随机森林 / top 10，前半段是 / top 11，后半段是 LASSO / top 13）。因此选择建立在三个指标的综合评分上，并且这一分歧被如实报告而非隐藏。

行业集中度。 在最终规则下，验证期单周最大的单一行业配置为 92.86%（`Sector_A`，第 103 周），其中 14 只持仓里有 13 只属于同一行业。10% 的单票上限并不施加任何行业上限。

> Each validation week the 80 assets are ranked by predicted excess return descending, ties broken by ascending asset id. Long-short equally weights the top 16 and shorts the bottom 16; long-only equally weights the top K and holds zero elsewhere. Sharpe = √52 × mean(r_p − r_f)/sd(r_p − r_f) and information ratio = √52 × mean(r_p − r_EW)/sd(r_p − r_EW), both with sample standard deviations. Maximum drawdown compounds total returns from wealth 1 and is reported as a nonpositive number. Transaction costs are ignored.
>
> **Table 6. Validation portfolios** (weeks 79–104; decimals)

Model / rule	Weekly long-short spread	Long-only Sharpe	IR vs equal weight	Max drawdown
OLS / top 16	+0.0220083	4.4530	7.8654	−0.0477
LASSO / top 16	+0.0208958	4.4086	10.3092	−0.0478
Random forest / top 16	+0.0244138	4.8950	9.8742	−0.0426
80-asset equal weight	—	1.7803	0.0000	−0.0777

> **Does the best prediction model produce the best portfolio? No.** The best validation prediction is LASSO (OOS R^2 +0.0087), yet the largest long-short spread and the best long-only Sharpe both belong to the random forest, whose OOS R^2 is negative (−0.0416). OOS R^2 measures the numerical fit of the *level* of returns; a top-K rule uses only the cross-sectional *order* of forecasts within a week, and scaling every forecast of a week by the same positive constant would leave the holdings unchanged. The two models therefore differ in the ranking itself, not in how dispersed their forecasts are: LASSO keeps 4 of the 17 slopes and those slopes are not a common multiple of the OLS slopes, while the forest partitions assets on thresholds and interactions. Model form, not shrinkage of the forecast scale, is what moves the top-K rule.

Selecting K. Thirty-three long-only top-K rules (K ∈ {10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 20, 24, 32, 40} × 3 models; a K below 10 would breach the 10% cap) are scored with the metric weights Sharpe 8 / IR 6 / drawdown 6. To avoid picking the K that looks best on one stretch of weeks, the weighted percentile score is computed separately on the full validation block and on each of its two halves, and candidates are ranked on the **mean** of the three window scores.

Table 7. Eight highest-ranked candidates by three-window composite

Model / rule	Sharpe	IR	Max drawdown	Composite
Random forest / top 14	**5.1522**	**10.1914**	**−0.0402**	**17.131**
Random forest / top 15	4.8799	10.3675	−0.0452	15.596
Random forest / top 16	4.8950	9.8742	−0.0426	14.263
Random forest / top 11	5.1993	9.4462	−0.0434	14.222
Random forest / top 10	5.4809	9.3871	−0.0484	14.121
OLS / top 10	5.1739	7.5019	−0.0416	14.040
Random forest / top 20	4.6504	11.2416	−0.0436	13.939
Random forest / top 13	4.9822	8.8525	−0.0424	13.697

The winner, random forest / top 14, has composite 17.131 against 15.596 for the runner-up, and its weakest window score (15.091) is the highest worst-window score of any candidate — the selection does not rest on one lucky window.

What the stability checks do not show. Single metrics disagree: the highest full-block Sharpe is random forest / top 10 (5.4809), the highest information ratio is random forest / top 20 (11.2416), and the shallowest drawdown is OLS / top 11 (−0.0395). The Sharpe-maximising K also moves between windows (random forest / top 10 on the full block, / top 11 in the first half, LASSO / top 13 in the second). Selection is therefore made on a composite of all three metrics, and the disagreement is reported rather than hidden.

Sector concentration. Under the final rule the largest single-sector allocation during validation is 92.86% (`Sector_A`, week 103), where 13 of the 14 holdings share the same bucket. The 10% single-name cap imposes no sector cap.

7. Final weights for the evaluation window | 评估窗口的最终权重

标准化器与所选森林在第 1–104 周的全部 8,320 行上重拟合一次，随后冻结。对评估窗口的每一个周，只用该周的 17 个预测因子给 80 只资产打分、排名，并给前 14 名各分配 1/14。模型在评估窗口内从不重拟合，任何被隐藏的结果都没有被使用，预测之所以变化只是因为输入在变。

权重文件包含 156 行 × 81 列，按日期顺序排列，保留八位小数，每周恰好 14 个非零项、取值 1/14 = 7.142857%，每行求和为 1（在舍入精度内）。覆盖 156 周评估窗口的权重文件写入 `outputs/portfolio_weights.csv`。

实质性风险：共同行业冲击下的集中度。 在 156 个评估周中，最大单一行业配置平均为 **62.2%**，在 **17** 周超过 80%，并在 **2** 周达到 **100%**。在其中任何一周发生行业冲击，相对于 80 只等权基准都会被放大。这属于组合层面的风险，而非有意的行业押注——这种拥挤可能来自行业级信号、来自行业共同波动，或来自样本结构——此处如实披露，而不把它归因于单一原因。第二项风险是：规则是在 26 个验证周上选出的，因此这一选择偏乐观，年化数字并不代表一年的独立证据。

> The scaler and the selected forest are refit once on all 8,320 rows of weeks 1–104 and then frozen. For each of the 156 evaluation weeks, only that week's 17 predictors are used to score the 80 assets, rank them and assign 1/14 to the top 14. The model is never refitted in the evaluation window, no withheld outcome is used anywhere, and forecasts change only because the inputs change.
>
> The weight file holds 156 rows × 81 columns, keeps the weeks in date order, uses eight decimal places, holds exactly 14 non-zero entries per week at 1/14 = 7.142857%, and every row sums to 1 within rounding. Files for the full 156-week evaluation window are written to `outputs/portfolio_weights.csv`.
>
> **Material risk: concentration in common sector shocks.** Across the 156 evaluation weeks the largest sector allocation averages **62.2%**, exceeds 80% in **17** weeks and reaches **100%** in **2**. A sector shock in one of those weeks would be amplified relative to the 80-asset equal-weight benchmark. This is a portfolio-level risk rather than a deliberate sector bet — the crowding may come from sector-level signal, from sector co-movement, or from the sample structure — and it is disclosed rather than attributed to a single cause. A second risk is that the rule was chosen on 26 validation weeks, so the selection is optimistic and the annualised figures do not represent a year of independent evidence.

8. Reproducibility | 可复现性

主脚本 Main script	`src/pipeline.py`（全部七个阶段、每一张表与图）
环境 Environment	Python 3.13.14、numpy 2.5.3、pandas 3.0.5、scikit-learn 1.9.1、matplotlib 3.11.2
确定性 Determinism	随机种子 2026 用于森林；OLS、循环坐标 LASSO 与每周排序均为确定性
复现命令 Reproduction	`python data/make_synthetic_data.py && python src/pipeline.py`
机器可读结果	`outputs/results.json`， `outputs/tables/` 下每张表一个 CSV

"可复现"在这里意味着什么、不意味着什么。 研究面板不可再分发，因此随仓库提供的生成器写出的面板具有相同的 schema、划分、周度日历与行业分组规模，但其**预测结构是刻意不同的。**重跑因此可以复现代码路径、断言以及每一项产物的形状，但会选出不同的组合规则、给出不同的比率。本报告与 `outputs/` 中的数字是原始面板上的研究运行结果；一次生成器上的运行验证的是"方法能够端到端执行"，而不是"这些数字会重现"。

流水线内部会执行两项检查，二者的性质不同，需要分别说清楚：

1. **求和稳健性检查。** 零超额收益的验证 MSE 用精确求和（`math.fsum`）重算，与 numpy 成对均值实现的差为 **0.0**。它验证的是求和顺序不会改变结果，**而不是**验证这个基准本身定义是否正确——两者算的是同一个量。
2. **树均值检查。** 冻结森林的验证预测等于其 300 棵树预测的均值（1e-14 容差内）。这是一次真正的独立实现核对。

另有一项**仿射不变性诊断**：把输入替换为 3·Z+7 后重拟合，最大预测偏差为 **8.67e-19**，相对于预测尺度（1.44e-02）的比值为 **6.0e-17**。严格说这是一项诊断而非硬不变量——在精确算术下正仿射重映射不改变划分，但在浮点下两个几乎并列的分裂增益可能翻转，使某些样本跨过阈值。因此这里报告它与尺度的比值，而不是声称一个在浮点下无法保证的界。

标识符在**数据载入时**被统一匿名化：行业分组按字母序映射为 `Sector_A`、`Sector_B`…，代码与公司名映射为 `asset_NN` / `Asset NN`。因此任何表格、日志行或 JSON 都不可能携带真实标识——匿名化由代码保证，而不是靠事后编辑。

本报告中每一句"最好 / 最多 / 唯一"的陈述，都是从流水线写入 `outputs/tables/` 的表格中读出的，而不是手工断言的。`outputs/` 中的全部产物——表格、`results.json`、`run_log.txt`、权重文件与四张图——都是同一次运行的直接输出，没有事后编辑。

Main script	`src/pipeline.py` (all seven stages, every table and figure)
Environment	Python 3.13.14, numpy 2.5.3, pandas 3.0.5, scikit-learn 1.9.1, matplotlib 3.11.2
Reproducibility	Deterministic: seed 2026 for the forest; OLS, cyclic-coordinate LASSO and the weekly sorts are deterministic
Reproduction	`python data/make_synthetic_data.py && python src/pipeline.py`
Machine-readable results	`outputs/results.json`, one CSV per table in `outputs/tables/`

What "reproduction" does and does not mean here. The study panel cannot be redistributed, so the shipped generator writes a panel with the identical schema, splits, weekly calendar and industry-bucket sizes but a deliberately different predictive structure. Re-running therefore reproduces the code path, the assertions and the shape of every artefact, but selects a different portfolio rule and reports different ratios. The numbers in this report and in `outputs/` are the study run on the original panel; a generated run verifies that the method executes end to end, not that these figures recur.

Two checks are run inside the pipeline, and they are not the same kind of check:

1. **Summation robustness.** The zero-excess-return validation MSE is recomputed by exact summation (`math.fsum`); the gap against numpy's pairwise mean is **0.0**. It verifies that summation order does not change the result — not that the benchmark is defined correctly, which is the same quantity.
2. **Mean-of-trees.** The frozen forest's validation prediction equals the mean of its 300 tree predictions (within 1e-14). This one is a genuine independent re-implementation.

A third item is an **affine-invariance diagnostic**: refitting on 3·Z+7 moves predictions by at most **8.67e-19**, a ratio of **6.0e-17** to the prediction scale (1.44e-02). In exact arithmetic a positive affine remap leaves the partition unchanged; under floating point two near-tied split gains can flip and move a row across a threshold. The diagnostic is therefore reported as a ratio to the scale, rather than as a bound that floating point cannot guarantee.

Identifiers are anonymised **once, at data load**: industry buckets are mapped in sorted order to `Sector_A`, `Sector_B`, …, and tickers and company names to `asset_NN` / `Asset NN`. No table, log line or JSON blob can therefore carry a real identifier — the guarantee is enforced in code, not by editing afterwards.

Every "best / most / only" statement in this report is read from the tables the pipeline writes to `outputs/tables/`, not asserted by hand. Every artefact in `outputs/` — the tables, `results.json`, `run_log.txt`, the weight file and the four figures — is the direct output of a single run, with nothing edited afterwards.

9. Limitations | 局限

- **收益为模拟数据。** 面板的收益与信号是模拟的，因此无法对真实市场得出任何推断。
- **只有 26 个验证周。** 规则是在 26 个周度观测上选出的，因此年化比率偏乐观。
- **不含成本。** 交易成本、借贷成本与流动性约束均被忽略；所有规则按周再平衡。
- **行业集中度**（见上节）未受控制。
- **评估窗口未报告。** 其结果被隐藏，因此最终权重是在与实盘部署相同的纪律下产出的，而它们的实际表现无法在此展示。

- **Simulated returns.** The panel's returns and signals are simulated, so no inference about real markets can be drawn.

- **26 validation weeks.** The portfolio rule was chosen on 26 weekly observations, so the annualised ratios are optimistic.
- **No costs.** Transaction costs, borrow costs and liquidity constraints are ignored; the rules rebalance weekly.
- **Sector concentration**, disclosed above, is not controlled for.
- **The evaluation window is unreported.** Its outcomes are withheld, so the final weights are produced under the same discipline as a live deployment and their realised performance cannot be shown here.